The International Space Station

Six space agencies representing 16 nations built and run the International Space Station. The ISS is an inhabited artificial satellite that orbits about 430 kilometres above the Earth's surface. Many scientific experiments are conducted on the station.

- Module length: 51 metres
- Truss length: 109 metres
- Solar array length: 73 metres
- Mass: 390 908 kilograms
- Habitable volume: 388 cubic metres
- Pressurised volume: 916 cubic metres
- Power generation: 8 solar arrays = 84 kilowatts in total
- Lines of computer code: approximately 2.3 million

Source: http://www.nasa.gov/mission_pages/station/main/onthestation/facts_and_figures.html

This information is in metric measures. Scientists all use metric measurements so that they can easily compare their information without having to convert the measurements first.

- A soccer pitch is 105 metres long by 68 metres wide.
- A singles tennis court is 24 metres long by 8 metres wide.
- A Holden Cruze diesel car has a mass of about 1500 kilograms.
- An Olympic swimming pool is about 2500 cubic metres.
- A suburban house may generate 2 kilowatts of solar power.

☞ **1** Fill in the gaps using the information above. You may wish to use a calculator. Round the answers down to the nearest whole number.

The space station module is a little over _____ tennis courts long. Its mass is equal to about _____ cars. The truss length is about _____ soccer pitches long. The pressurised volume is [more than/less than] half of an Olympic swimming pool. The space station has exactly ____ times the solar power capacity of a suburban house.

2 Sort out the jumbled nations to complete the sentence.

Most of the international space station cooperation is between the SUA (_____), PORUEE (_____), APNAJ (_____), SIARSU (_____), NAACAD (_____) and LRBAZI (_____). Eleven nations share the space agency of Europe.

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